LESSON 10

Present Simple

We use the Present Simple to talk about:

- general truths

The Earth go**es** around the Sun.

Vegetarians **don't** eat meat.

Budapest **is** the capital of Hungary.

- routines and habits

Peter always **has** ham and eggs for breakfast.

We play tennis every afternoon.

I usually get up at 7 in the morning.

- feelings or activities of the mind

I want to go home.

Alice like**s** muffins.

I think you are right.

Time expressions often used with the Present Simple:

- **always, often, usually, sometimes, rarely, never**
- **every day/week/month/year**
- **once/twice/three times a day/week/month/year**

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Formation rules (also see the tables below):

- in 3rd person singular verbs take an **-s** (e.g. like**s**, sing**s**, dance**s**)
- verbs ending with -y: in spelling ***-y*** turns into ***-ie*** when the verbs end in a consonant + -y (e.g. study – studies, try – tries, worry – worries)
- **questions** are formed with *do,* or *does* in 3rd person singular and the bare infinitive

  Do you like coffee?

  Does she usually go to work at 8?

  Do they need help?

- **negatives** are formed with *do not (don't),* or *does not (doesn't)* in the 3rd person singular and the bare infinitive

  We **don't** spend our holidays abroad.

  Melissa **doesn't** like the new teacher.

  I **don't** understand Maths.

Affirmative

I You We They	live	in Trieste.
He/She/(It)	lives	

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Negative

I You We They	do not (don't) live	in Trieste.
He/She/(It)	does not (doesn't) live	

Interrogative

Do	I you we they	live	in Trieste?
Does	he/she/(it)	live	

The present tense forms of ***to be***

Affirmative

I	am	very busy.
He/She/(It)	is	
We You They	are	

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Negative

I	am not ('m not)	very busy.
He/She/(It)	is not (isn't)	
We You They	are not (aren't)	

Interrogative

Am	I	very busy?
Is	he/she/(it)	
Are	we you they	

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